

NightPilot

GTM Playbook

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What You're Looking At

NightPilot is a taste engine for going out. Users swipe on restaurants and bars to teach it what they like, then it tells them exactly where to eat and drink tonight — personalized plans with a restaurant + bar pairing, walk time between them, and a plain-English explanation of why it fits. Wine Lens lets users photograph a wine menu and get instant recommendations based on their taste profile, what they're eating, and their budget.

It's live now. Mobile web app, no download required. Four cities, 138 curated venues, all verified open. The taste profile is portable — build it in one city, get personalized recs the moment you land in another.

City	Venues	Restaurants	Bars	Status
Amsterdam	33	18	15	Primary GTM target — you are here
Vancouver	35	18	17	Strong food scene, high tourist volume
Dublin	35	18	17	Tourist + local, pub culture crossover
Salt Lake City	35	20	15	Jordan is local, dogfooding daily

How the Taste Engine Works

Every venue in the app carries 6-8 descriptive tags — things like "intimate," "craft-cocktails," "italian," "date-night," "lively." When a user swipes right (like), every tag on that venue gets a +1 in their profile. Swipe up (save) gives +2. Swipe left (reject) gives -1. Over 10-15 swipes, the system builds a weighted map of what that person actually responds to.

On top of tags, the engine tracks price sensitivity (which price tier they swipe right on most) and neighborhood affinity (where they gravitate). When they enter "Build My Night" mode and pick an occasion — date, group dinner, solo — the engine layers in mood-matching: a date query boosts venues tagged romantic/intimate/upscale, a group query boosts lively/shareable/casual.

Scoring is additive. A venue with 3 tags the user has historically loved and is in their preferred price range and neighborhood will score significantly higher than one with only partial overlap. The recommendations

then pair a restaurant and a bar that complement each other — walkable distance, complementary vibes — and present the top 3 pairings with match percentages.

The critical point: this profile travels. Someone who builds their taste in Amsterdam gets instant personalized recommendations when they open the app in Vancouver. No other product has a cross-city personal taste graph for nightlife. That's the moat.

Why This Is a Real Business

The problem is universal: deciding where to go out is broken for anyone who cares about quality. Google reviews are noisy and generic. Asking friends doesn't scale to new cities. "Best Of" lists aren't personalized. The market is everyone aged 25-45 with disposable income who eats out 2-4x per month — hundreds of millions of people globally.

The risk asymmetry works in our favor: worst case, someone has a mediocre meal. That's a \$50, 2-hour downside. Compare that to trusting a new fintech or health app. People will try this. And every bad recommendation feeds back into the engine to make the next one better.

Revenue Streams

Booking referrals: When a NightPilot recommendation leads to a Resy or OpenTable reservation, we take a referral fee. We're driving high-intent, qualified traffic — someone who's already been told "this is your place tonight" converts at multiples of a generic browser.

Premium subscription: \$10/month for power users who go out 3-4x per week. Unlimited Wine Lens scans, priority recommendations, saved plans, group planning features. The person who relies on NightPilot for every dinner is paying for the decision being made for them — same psychology as ClassPass or a personal stylist.

Wine commerce: The taste profile knows what wines a user likes. We can recommend bottles to buy for home via partnerships with wine retailers. Take-rate on every bottle sold.

B2B licensing: Hotels, airlines, and premium credit cards (Amex Centurion, Chase Sapphire) want to offer "where to eat" recommendations to their guests and members. Our engine can power that. White-label the taste graph as an API.

Venue partnerships: Not pay-for-placement — that kills trust. Instead, venues pay for insights: "here's what your ideal customer looks like based on who NightPilot sends your way." CRM for restaurants powered by taste data.

The Exit

The acquirer is someone who needs a portable taste graph for experiences. Airbnb owns where you stay but has been trying to own what you do (Experiences) without cracking personalization. Booking.com, same story. Amex and Chase Sapphire spend billions on cardholder retention — their concierge services are still humans Googling restaurants. We build the dataset that makes personalized experience recommendations actually work, and we sell to whoever needs it most.

With 500K profiled users across 20+ cities, the taste graph becomes an asset worth 9 figures to the right buyer. The path: prove retention in 4 cities, raise a seed, expand to 15-20 cities, prove cross-city usage,

and the acquisition conversations start themselves.

Your Role: AE Motion for Consumer Growth

You know how to run outbound. Same motion you run at Datadog — build a target list, run structured outreach, track conversations in a pipeline, qualify, activate, expand through intros. The difference is the "close" here isn't a contract — it's getting someone to use NightPilot next time they go out and tell you what happened. Revenue comes later. Right now we're buying retention data with your time.

Target Lists — Per City

Start with Amsterdam. Replicate once the playbook proves out.

50 Influencers — Food and drink creators on Instagram and TikTok. 5K-100K followers. Local, not mega-influencers. They create authentic content that drives installs. One Wine Lens video from the right person means hundreds of new users.

50 Venue Operators — Restaurant and bar owners, GMs, sommeliers. Start with the 33 venues already in our Amsterdam data. If a venue tells their customers "use NightPilot for wine recs here," that's embedded distribution.

50 Social Organizers — People who run supper clubs, group dinners, nightlife guides, "things to do" accounts. They have audiences actively needing what we offer and they curate, which aligns with our brand.

25 Local Media — City newsletters, food blogs, local guides, Time Out contributors, city subreddits. Earned media from trusted local sources converts better than any paid channel.

Outreach Motion

Run it like a pipeline. Six stages:

- 1. Research** — Find the person, understand their audience or venue, personalize your angle. This is account mapping.
- 2. First Touch** — DM or email. Short, specific, show you know them. No generic pitch. Cold outbound.
- 3. Follow-up** — 2-3 follow-ups spaced 3-5 days. Add value each time: share their content, comment on their posts, reference something specific. Sequence cadence.
- 4. Discovery** — Get on a call or meet in person. Demo the app live. Ask what would make them use or share it. Discovery call.
- 5. Activation** — Get them to actually use NightPilot. Send the link. Check in after their night out. Did it work? This is the POC.
- 6. Expansion** — Ask for intros. "Who else would love this?" Turn one activated user into five. Expand and referral.

CRM: Spreadsheet or Notion. Columns: Name, Segment, City, Platform, Followers/Reach, Stage, Last Touch, Next Action, Notes. Update daily. Review weekly with Jordan.

Messaging By Segment

Influencers — Lead with Wine Lens. It's visual, demo-able, looks like magic on camera. Don't pitch, show. The content angle writes itself: "Let AI pick my wine." Offer early access and a direct line to the founders, not payment.

Venue Operators — Lead with: "Your restaurant is already in our app and being recommended to people who match your vibe." You're not selling anything. You're telling them something is already happening. The ask: try it, give feedback, mention it to guests who ask for wine help.

Social Organizers — Lead with the group use case. "Next time you're planning dinner for 8 and everyone has different tastes — try this." They organize constantly. Give them a tool that reduces the coordination tax.

Local Media — Pitch the story, not the product. "A founder built an AI that learns your taste in restaurants and tells you where to go tonight — it already knows 33 spots in Amsterdam." Local tech plus local food equals local press.

Content That Drives Usage

You don't need to be a content creator. You need to create moments others can capture.

Wine Lens in the wild: Scan a real wine menu on camera. Show the rec. Order it. React. 30 seconds.

"AI picked my night": Full flow — swipe, build a night, follow the rec, show up, film the experience.

Blind taste test: NightPilot rec vs. friend's rec vs. Google's top result. Which one wins?

Sommelier challenge: Wine Lens vs. the sommelier. Who picks better for the table?

Tourist test: Give a tourist NightPilot on day one in Amsterdam. Follow their night. Genuine reactions.

Amsterdam — Why It's the Beachhead

You're physically there. That means you can do things that don't scale — and at this stage, those are the things that matter most:

Walk into venues and demo Wine Lens to the sommelier live

Attend food and drink events. Seed the app in real conversations.

Meet influencers for coffee instead of cold DMing

Use the product yourself every time you go out — your feedback is first-party data

Build a local network of 10-15 super-users who give you regular feedback

Why Amsterdam specifically: high tourist density (people who genuinely don't know where to go), compact walkable city (our neighborhood recommendations are perfectly suited), strong food and drink culture where discovery is hard for visitors, and English-friendly enough that the app works without localization.

First 4 Weeks

Week 1 — Setup

- Use NightPilot 3-4 times yourself. Build your taste profile. Try Wine Lens at dinner.
- Set up your CRM spreadsheet
- Build initial target list: 25 influencers, 25 venue operators, 15 organizers, 10 media
- Identify your top 10 accounts — people whose endorsement would actually move the needle

Week 2 — First Wave

- Send 30 personalized DMs and emails (prioritize influencers and organizers)
- Respond to every reply within 24 hours
- Visit 3-5 venues in person. Demo the app. Get a name and a reaction.
- Record 1-2 short Wine Lens clips for your own socials

Week 3 — Follow-up and Expand

- Second and third touches on Week 2 outreach
- Book discovery calls or coffee with anyone who engaged
- Second wave: 20 new outreach messages
- Ask every activated user: "Who else would love this?"

Week 4 — Review and Double Down

- Review pipeline with Jordan. What messaging worked? What segment responded?
- Share qualitative feedback — what users said, what they asked for, what surprised them
- Double down on whatever segment showed the strongest signal
- Begin scoping the playbook for city #2

What You're Measuring

Your Pipeline (you own these):

- Outreach volume: 30-50 personalized touches per week
- Reply rate: benchmark 15-25% for quality DMs
- Discovery calls booked per week
- Activations: people who actually used the app after your outreach
- Expansion: intros generated from each activation

Product Health (Jordan owns, you monitor):

Swipe completion: do people finish 10+ swipes? Target is above 60%

Night Mode conversion: do swipers build a night? Target is above 40%

Wine Lens scans per city per week

7-day return rate — target is above 30%

Cross-city usage: any signal here validates the entire thesis

What 90-Day Success Looks Like

100+ people in Amsterdam have used NightPilot at least once

30%+ came back a second time without being prompted

3-5 influencers have posted Wine Lens or NightPilot content organically

5+ venue operators know NightPilot by name and have tried it

A repeatable outreach playbook ready to deploy in city #2

A CRM with 200+ contacts, clear stage data, and a pipeline you can report on

Enough retention signal to inform a fundraising conversation

Working Together

Jordan owns product. You own distribution. The interface is feedback and data:

Weekly sync: 30 min. Pipeline numbers, qualitative signal, what users are asking for.

Bug reports: City, device, what happened. Don't troubleshoot — just relay.

Feature requests: Track them. Don't promise anything. Jordan decides what ships.

Venue corrections: Closed, moved, wrong hours — flag immediately.

Wins: Screenshot every positive reaction. Every share. Every piece of content. Build a wall of proof.

NightPilot — the world's first portable taste graph for going out.

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